

Planets in order from the Sun

The Sun was created from a vast cloud of gas and dust about 4.6 billion years ago. Parts of the cloud that were left over gathered together and formed the eight planets of the solar system. The planets, which all follow an elliptical (oval) orbit around the Sun, range enormously in size and structure. The four planets

closest to the Sun are spheres made of rock and metal. The four larger, outer planets (known as the gas planets) have a dense gas exterior surrounding a layer of liquid. Beneath the liquid layer is a rocky core. All four have rings and many moons.

